SSBT's COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

Bambhori, Jalgaon – 425001 (MS)

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING

A Minor Project Report

on

VIRTUAL HERBAL GARDEN

Submitted in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the Third Year of

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering

Affiliated to **Kavayitri Bahinabai Chaudhari North Maharashtra University, Jalgaon**

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Academic Year: 2024–25

Certificate

This is to certify that the minor project entitled **"Virtual Herbal Garden"**, submitted by

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in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of **Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering** has been satisfactorily carried out under my guidance as per the requirement of **Kavayitri Bahinabai Chaudhari North Maharashtra University, Jalgaon**.

Date: April 19, 2025 Place: Jalgaon

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Acknowledgement

We would like to thank Dr. Surendra Ramteke, Associate Professor and Project Guide, for his dedicated efforts in guiding us toward achieving our goals and for his encouragement in helping us maintain consistent progress.

We also express our gratitude to Prof. Dr. Girish K. Patnaik, Principal, and Dr. Manoj E. Patil, Head of Department, for providing us with the opportunity and resources.

Our heartfelt thanks go to Almighty God for the strength to complete this work.

Finally, we thank Miss Shital A. Patil, Assistant Professor and BE Project In-Charge, for her guidance throughout the project.

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Abstract

The **Virtual Herbal Garden** project aims to create an interactive online platform that educates users about the importance of herbal plants, their growth phases, and medicinal properties. With the growing interest in natural remedies and sustainable gardening, this virtual garden provides an immersive experience for users to explore various herbs, their uses, and the environmental conditions required for their cultivation. The project combines web development technologies with an intuitive design, allowing users to navigate through plant profiles, view growth stages, and access detailed information on each herb .The website is designed with user interaction in mind, featuring search functionalities, plant details, and a visual representation of plant growth phases. By simulating the growth of plants from germination to harvesting, users gain a comprehensive understanding of the life cycle of herbs. Additionally, the platform offers educational resources to promote the use of herbs in daily life, whether for medicinal, culinary, or cosmetic purposes .The project leverages technologies such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and backend frameworks to ensure a smooth user experience. User feedback and testing have been integral to refining the platform, and the project is designed to be scalable, allowing for future enhancements and the inclusion of additional features, such as mobile support or augmented reality .In conclusion, the Virtual Herbal Garden is not only a tool for learning about herbs but also a step towards preserving and promoting knowledge about natural plants in a digital format ,encouraging users to connect with nature in a new and engaging way.

Introduction

Background

The use of herbs in various aspects of life, such as medicine, food, and cosmetics, has a long history, dating back thousands of years. Herbal plants have been relied upon for their therapeutic properties, offering natural remedies for a wide range of ailments. In many cultures, herbal knowledge is passed down through generations, forming an essential part of traditional medicine. Despite their importance, the knowledge surrounding herbs and their cultivation has often been confined to specific regions or communities, limiting access to this valuable information.

Motivation

The motivation behind the **Virtual Herbal Garden** project stems from several key factors, all rooted in the desire to bridge the gap between traditional herbal knowledge and modern technological advancements. Below are the core motivators that inspired the creation of this project:

Rising Interest in Herbal Remedies and Sustainability

In recent years, there has been a growing shift toward more natural and sustainable lifestyles. People are increasingly turning to herbal remedies and home-grown plants for their health benefits, as well as their environmental and economic advantages. With the global push for sustainability, individuals are looking for ways to reduce their reliance on synthetic products and explore alternative solutions for health, food, and beauty. However, many people lack the knowledge or resources to start cultivating and using herbs effectively. The **Virtual Herbal Garden** aims to meet this demand by providing an easy-to-access platform that educates users about the diverse world of herbal plants and their potential benefits.

Education and Awareness

Herbal plants are often underutilized due to a lack of awareness about their diverse applications, ranging from medicinal and culinary uses to their ecological value. The project seeks to raise awareness by offering detailed profiles of various herbs, including information on their growth stages, medicinal properties, and tips for cultivation. It is crucial to empower individuals with knowledge so that they can make informed choices about incorporating herbs into their daily lives, whether for health, food, or even natural home care products.

Overcoming Physical and Knowledge Barriers

Not everyone has the opportunity to cultivate an herb garden at home, particularly in urban environments where space is limited. Additionally, some individuals may not have the expertise or guidance to grow herbs effectively. By creating a **virtual** herbal garden, the project eliminates the need for physical space or experience, allowing anyone, regardless of location or gardening knowledge, to explore and learn about herbs. Users can interact with the platform from the comfort of their own homes, making it an inclusive learning tool for all.

Problem Definition

The lack of accessible, engaging platforms to learn about herbal plants and their uses presents a barrier for individuals interested in incorporating herbs into their lives. Many people, especially in urban areas, have limited space or knowledge for cultivating their own herbal gardens. Furthermore, existing resources on herbal plants often lack interactive features, making it difficult for users to fully understand the growth stages and practical applications of these plants. Additionally, traditional educational methods do not provide an immersive experience, which could better engage users and help them retain information. The challenge is to create a platform that not only educates users about herbal plants but also provides an interactive, virtual experience that simulates plant growth, offers detailed herb profiles, and encourages sustainable gardening practices. This project aims to address these gaps by developing an accessible, informative,

and user-friendly Virtual Herbal Garden.

Scope

The Virtual Herbal Garden project aims to create an interactive web platform that educates users about various herbs, their medicinal properties, culinary uses, and growth phases. It will feature detailed profiles for each herb, including care instructions, environmental conditions, and growth stages. Users will be able to simulate plant growth, view informative content, and explore different herbs through a user-friendly interface. The platform will cater to a wide audience, from beginners to experienced gardeners, offering knowledge about sustainable gardening and herbal practices. Future expansion may include mobile app integration, augmented reality features, and the addition of more plant species to the garden.

Objectives

The primary objectives of the Virtual Herbal Garden project are as follows:

Educational Resource

To provide users with comprehensive information about various herbs, including their medicinal properties, culinary uses, and growth phases.

Interactive Experience

To create an engaging platform where users can interact with a virtual garden, explore different plants, and view their growth stages from germination to harvest.

User-Friendly Interface

To design a simple, intuitive interface that allows users to easily navigate through the website, search for specific herbs, and access plant profiles and care instructions.

Promote Sustainable Gardening

To encourage users to adopt sustainable gardening practices by educating them on the care and cultivation of herbs in small spaces or urban environments.

Raise Awareness

To foster a deeper understanding and appreciation for herbal plants and their ecological, medicinal, and culinary benefits.

Future Scalability

To build a scalable platform that can be expanded with additional plant species, features, and potential integrations with mobile apps or augmented reality for enhanced user engagement.

Selection Of Life Cycle Model

The software development life cycle model selected for this project is the **Waterfall Model**. Waterfall approach was the first SDLC (Software Development Life Cycle) Model to be widely used in software engineering to ensure success of the project. It was developed by Winston W. Royce in 1970. In "The Waterfall" approach, the whole process of software development is divided into separate phases, typically the outcome of one phase acts as the input for the next phase sequentially. All the phases are cascaded to each other in which progress is seen as flowing steadily downwards (like a waterfall) through the phases.

Waterfall Model Suitability for the Project

The key reasons for selecting the Waterfall Model for this project are:

- **Clear Requirements:** The project has well-defined objectives, such as creating a virtual garden, displaying plant profiles, and simulating plant growth stages. The Waterfall Model is ideal when the requirements are stable and unlikely to change frequently during development.

- **Structured Approach:** Since the project involves a sequence of logical steps—such as planning, design, development, and testing—the Waterfall Model provides a clear structure for each phase, ensuring a systematic and organized development process.
- **Predictable Timeline:** The Waterfall Model's linear progression makes it easier to predict timelines and resource allocation. Since the scope and features of the website are well-defined upfront, the development process can follow a structured path, making project management more straightforward.
- **Documentation and Traceability:** The Waterfall Model emphasizes documentation at every phase, which ensures that all aspects of the project are thoroughly recorded. This helps in maintaining a clear understanding of design decisions, feature specifications, and testing results, which is valuable for future reference and project maintenance.
- **Focused Development and Testing:** With each phase being completed before moving to the next, the Waterfall Model allows for focused development and testing. Once the design phase is completed, the development team can focus entirely on building the platform without the distractions of changing requirements.

Organization of Report

The **Virtual Herbal Garden** is an innovative project designed to educate users about the diverse range of medicinal plants used in traditional systems like Ayurveda and Homeopathy. It features an interactive virtual garden with 3D models, detailed plant information, and augmented reality capabilities, allowing users to visualize plants in real-world settings. Developed using Python, JavaScript, CSS, and HTML, this open-source project encourages contributions and collaboration through its GitHub platform. By blending technology with education, it aims to preserve and promote traditional medicinal knowledge, making it accessible and engaging for a global audience.

Summary

The **Virtual Herbal Garden** project is an innovative platform designed to educate and engage users in the world of herbal plants. The primary goal is to bridge the gap between traditional herbal knowledge and modern technology, making information about herbs, their growth, and their uses more accessible to a broad audience. The project addresses the growing interest in sustainable living and herbal remedies, providing an interactive, virtual garden where users can explore plant profiles, learn about their medicinal properties, and understand the stages of their growth. The platform was developed using the **Waterfall Model**, a structured approach that allowed for clear documentation, predictable timelines, and systematic development. The project features an easy-to-navigate interface that presents educational content, interactive simulations of plant growth, and guidance on sustainable gardening practices. It aims to overcome physical barriers to gardening by offering a virtual space for users to learn, regardless of their location or gardening experience.

Key motivations for the project include the increasing demand for natural, eco-friendly solutions, the need for accessible herbal education, and the desire to connect users with nature in an increasingly digital world. Through this platform, users can gain valuable knowledge on how to grow and use herbs, fostering a deeper appreciation for the environment and encouraging sustainable living practices.

The development process involved designing and implementing various features, followed by rigorous testing to ensure functionality and user satisfaction. The project was evaluated through feedback, which contributed to its refinement. The **Virtual Herbal Garden** has proven to be a valuable educational tool, offering users a dynamic and engaging way to learn about the importance of herbs in daily life, health, and sustainability.

In conclusion, the **Virtual Herbal Garden** serves as a comprehensive platform that empowers users with knowledge, promotes sustainable gardening, and encourages a stronger connection to nature. The project's success sets the foundation for future enhancements, ensuring its continued impact in the field of herbal education and sustainable living.

Project Planning and Management

Feasibility Study

The feasibility study for the **Virtual Herbal Garden** project evaluates the practical, technical, and financial aspects of the project to determine its viability. This assessment considers resources required, potential risks, and the project's overall achievability within defined parameters.

Technical Feasibility

Technical feasibility assesses whether the current technology, infrastructure, and expertise support the development and deployment of the Virtual Herbal Garden.

Technology Stack: The project is built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript for the front end, while the back end uses Python and MySQL for data management. These technologies are widely adopted, scalable, and well-documented, ensuring maintainability and growth.

Platform Requirements: Designed as a web-based system, the platform is accessible via any internet-enabled device. It requires minimal hardware and can be hosted on shared servers. Optimization for mobile and tablet views ensures broader accessibility.

Development Tools: The team uses Visual Studio Code for coding, GitHub for version control, and testing frameworks to ensure platform reliability. These tools are cost-effective and widely available.

Integration and Interactivity: Features like plant growth simulations and detailed herb profiles are integrated using responsive design principles to provide a smooth user experience on both desktop and mobile platforms.

Operational Feasibility

Operational feasibility examines the institution's capability to manage the platform post-development.

User Support: The platform includes clear navigation, informative content, a support page, FAQs, and a community forum for peer assistance.

Content Management: A CMS allows non-technical users to update herb profiles, growth stages, and care instructions easily.

Sustainability: Regular updates will be scheduled to ensure technological and content relevance. Security patches and performance checks will be performed periodically.

Risk Management: Potential issues such as server downtime or data breaches are mitigated through encryption, cloud hosting, and frequent backups.

Economic Feasibility

Economic feasibility measures the financial viability of the project.

Development Costs: Costs include labor, hosting, and software licenses. Most tools are open-source, reducing expenses significantly.

Maintenance Costs: Minimal, with most updates managed by a small team. Cloud hosting allows for scalable pricing.

Revenue Generation: Potential revenue streams include:

- **Advertising:** Herbal products, gardening tools, and eco-friendly services.
- **Premium Features:** Subscription-based advanced plant care tools and exclusive content.
- **Partnerships and Sponsorships:** Collaboration with sustainable brands and gardening companies.

Cost-Benefit Analysis: Given the low development and maintenance costs and potential revenue avenues, the project is considered financially sustainable.

Risk Analysis

Risk analysis identifies potential project risks and strategies to mitigate them.

Technical Risks

- **Risk:** Compatibility issues across browsers/devices
  Mitigation: Responsive design and cross-browser testing

- **Risk:** Security vulnerabilities

  Mitigation: Secure coding, SSL, encryption, and regular audits

- **Risk:** Performance bottlenecks

  Mitigation: Load testing, performance optimization, and monitoring

Operational Risks

- **Risk:** Low user engagement

  Mitigation: Interactive content, gamification, and feedback loops

- **Risk:** Difficult content maintenance

  Mitigation: CMS with simple UI for content updates

- **Risk:** Inefficient user support

  Mitigation: FAQ, support channels, and peer forums

Financial Risks

- **Risk:** Budget overruns

  Mitigation: Budget tracking and diversified revenue streams

- **Risk:** Inadequate revenue generation

  Mitigation: Affiliate marketing and targeted marketing

Market Risks

- **Risk:** Low demand or high competition

  Mitigation: Market research and feature differentiation

Project Scheduling

Project scheduling involves mapping the development timeline from planning to deployment.

Macroscopic Schedule: Broad phases such as planning, requirements gathering, design, development, testing, and deployment are outlined.

Detailed Schedule: Each phase is broken into tasks, with timelines, team responsibilities, and milestones clearly defined. The schedule remains flexible, adapting to unforeseen challenges through continuous review.

Effort Allocation

Effort allocation refers to distributing work based on task complexity and resource availability.

Workload is divided among planning, design, development, testing, and deployment. Tasks are assigned according to team expertise. Regular tracking ensures timely completion and allows for real-time adjustments as new challenges arise.

Cost Estimation

Cost estimation for the Virtual Herbal Garden is categorized into:

1. **Initial Costs:** Planning, research, and project management tools.
2. **Design and Development:** UI/UX, frontend, backend, and interactive feature integration.
3. **Software and Tools:** Licenses, hosting, and domain registration.
4. **Testing:** Usability, performance, and security testing.
5. **Deployment:** Live server setup and optimization.
6. **Maintenance:** Bug fixes, feature updates, and content management.

Summary

Project Planning and Management for the Virtual Herbal Garden follows a structured lifecycle:

- **Planning & Requirements:** Project scope and goal setting
- **Design:** Intuitive UI/UX for interactive herb simulations
- **Development:** Integration of frontend and backend components

- **Testing:** Performance and usability assurance
- **Deployment:** Platform go-live on secure servers
- **Maintenance:** Ongoing updates, security patches, and content growth

Resource optimization, time management, and risk mitigation ensure on-time, on-budget project delivery.

Analysis

Requirement Collection and Identification

The Requirement Collection and Identification phase is critical to understanding the project's objectives, the needs of the target users, and the technical specifications required to develop the **Virtual Herbal Garden**. This phase lays the foundation for the design and development processes by gathering and identifying both functional and non-functional requirements.

Functional Requirements

- **User Registration and Login:** Users should be able to create an account, log in, and manage their profiles. This enables personalized experiences, such as saving favorite herbs and tracking growth stages.
- **Herb Database:** A comprehensive database containing detailed profiles of various herbs, including their growth stages, medicinal properties, culinary uses, and care instructions.
- **Herb Growth Simulation:** Interactive features allowing users to visualize the growth stages of herbs, including visual progress over time.
- **Search and Filter:** Users should be able to search herbs by categories (e.g., medicinal, culinary) and filter by growth stage or requirements (e.g., light, water).
- **User Interaction:** Features for leaving comments or reviews on herbs and participating in quizzes or challenges.
- **Educational Content:** Information on sustainable herb growing, environmental benefits, and health applications.
- **Mobile and Desktop Compatibility:** Platform accessibility on desktop and mobile devices.

Non-Functional Requirements

- **Usability:** User-friendly UI/UX for users of all technical levels.
- **Performance:** Quick loading and efficient handling of multiple users.
- **Scalability:** Capacity to expand features and herb content.
- **Security:** Secure data storage with encryption.
- **Availability:** 24/7 access with minimal downtime.
- **Responsiveness:** Consistent behavior across screen sizes and devices.

Stakeholder Requirements

- **Target Audience:** Individuals interested in herbal gardening and sustainable living.
- **Content Creators and Admins:** Ability to manage and update herb profiles and user interactions.

Technical Requirements

- **Front-End Tools:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React.
- **Back-End Tools:** Node.js or Django.
- **Database:** MySQL or PostgreSQL.
- **Hosting:** AWS or DigitalOcean.

Software Requirements Specifications (SRS)

Product Features

1. **User Registration and Login:** Secure login, encrypted passwords, profile management.
2. **Herb Database:** Includes botanical info, uses, images, growth visualizations.

3. **Interactive Growth Simulation:** Real-time simulations from seedling to maturity.
4. **Search and Filtering:** Advanced filters by herb properties and preferences.
5. **Educational Content:** Tutorials, articles, videos on herbs and sustainability.
6. **Community Interaction:** Comments, forums, quizzes, and ratings.
7. **Cross-platform Compatibility:** Responsive on mobile and desktop.
8. **Progress Tracking:** Personalized dashboard, virtual garden, learning tracker.
9. **Sustainability Focus:** Eco-friendly tips, composting guides, and more.

Operating Environment

- **Hardware Requirements:** Multi-core CPU, 8GB+ RAM, 100GB+ storage, internet access.
- **User Devices:** PCs, smartphones/tablets (Android/iOS), 2 Mbps+ connection.
- **Server OS:** Ubuntu/CentOS/Windows Server/macOS.
- **Client OS:** Compatible with latest versions of Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari.
- **Frameworks:** HTML5, CSS3, React, Node.js, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB.
- **CMS:** Optional for content and herb profile management.
- **Hosting:** AWS, GCP, DigitalOcean.
- **Third-party Tools:** Weather APIs, payment gateways, Google Analytics, SSL/TLS.

Network Requirements

- **Internet Access:** High-speed internet for seamless loading.
- **Firewall/Security:** Configured firewall, VPNs for secure development.

User Environment

- **Device Support:** Desktop, mobile, tablet.
- **UX Design:** Responsive, fast-loading (<3 sec), media-optimized.

Development Environment

- **IDEs:** VS Code, PyCharm, WebStorm.
- **Version Control:** Git, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket.
- **Containerization:** Docker for consistent environments.

Summary

The **Virtual Herbal Garden** project is aimed at educating users on herbal plants and sustainable living. This analysis phase lays out comprehensive requirements—both functional and non-functional—ensuring a robust, engaging, and scalable platform. Security, multilingual support, and cloud-based infrastructure ensure reliability and wide reach. Features like quizzes, simulations, and API integrations elevate user engagement. With a clear plan, the platform is technically feasible and ready for the next stages of development and deployment.

Design

System Architecture

The Virtual Herbal Garden is designed using a client-server architecture. The frontend is accessible via both desktop and mobile browsers, while the backend handles user interactions, data management, and content delivery. A cloud-based infrastructure like AWS is used for deployment and scalability.

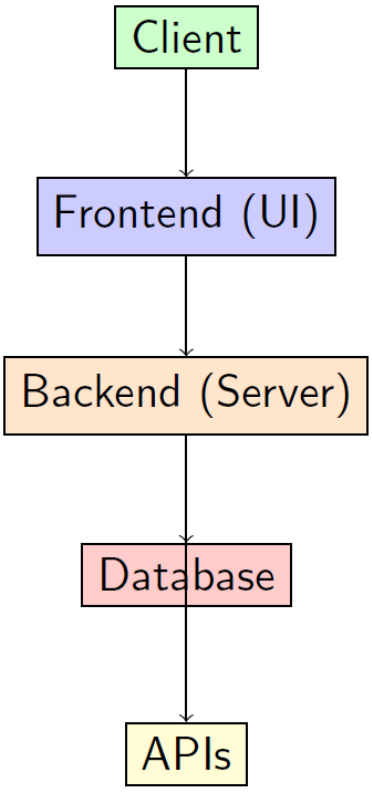

Figure: System Architecture of Virtual Herbal Garden

Data Flow Diagram (DFD)

The DFD shows how information flows between system modules and user inputs/outputs.

Level 0: Context Diagram

External entities: User, Admin, Third-party APIs. System: Virtual Herbal Garden.

Level 1: High-Level Diagram

- **User Registration and Login**
- **Herb Data Management**
- **Interactive Features**
- **Feedback System**
- **Admin Tools**
- **Third-Party Integration**

UML Diagrams

Use Case Diagram

Use case diagrams illustrate user-system interactions.

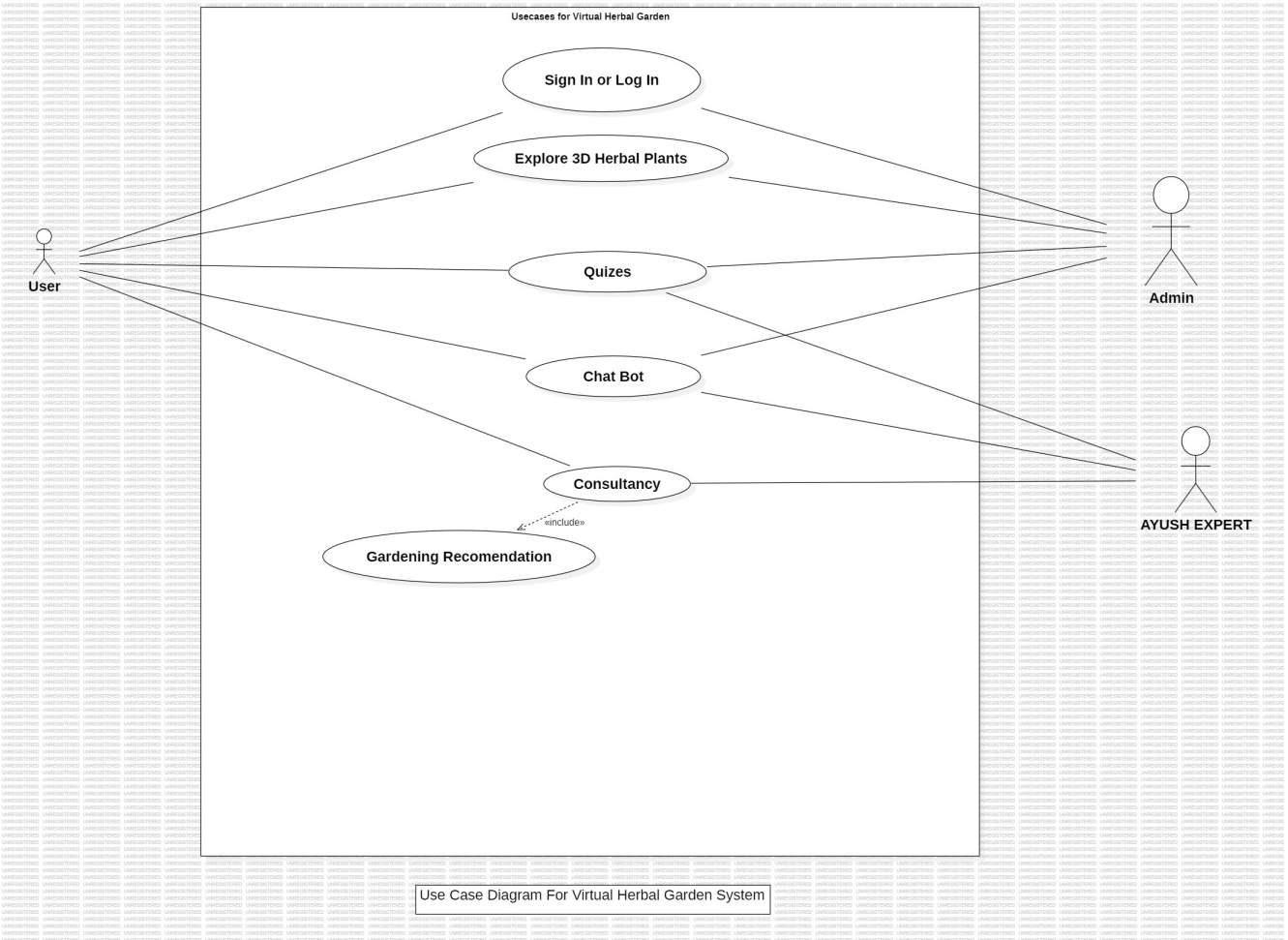

Figure: Use Case Diagram

Sequence Diagram

Shows how processes interact over time.

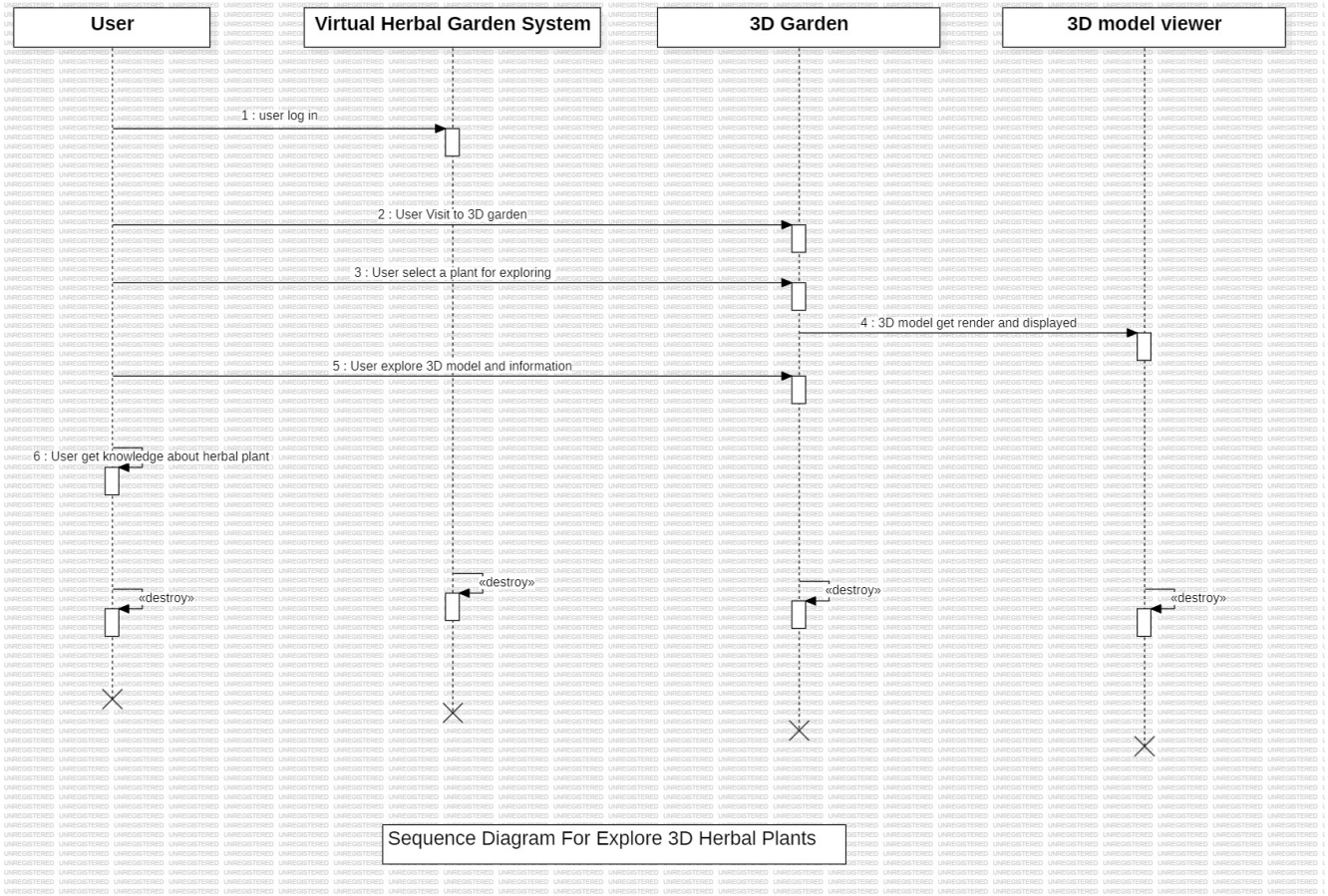

Figure: Sequence Diagram

Communication Diagram

Illustrates system interaction between various componets for 3D herbal garden usecase.

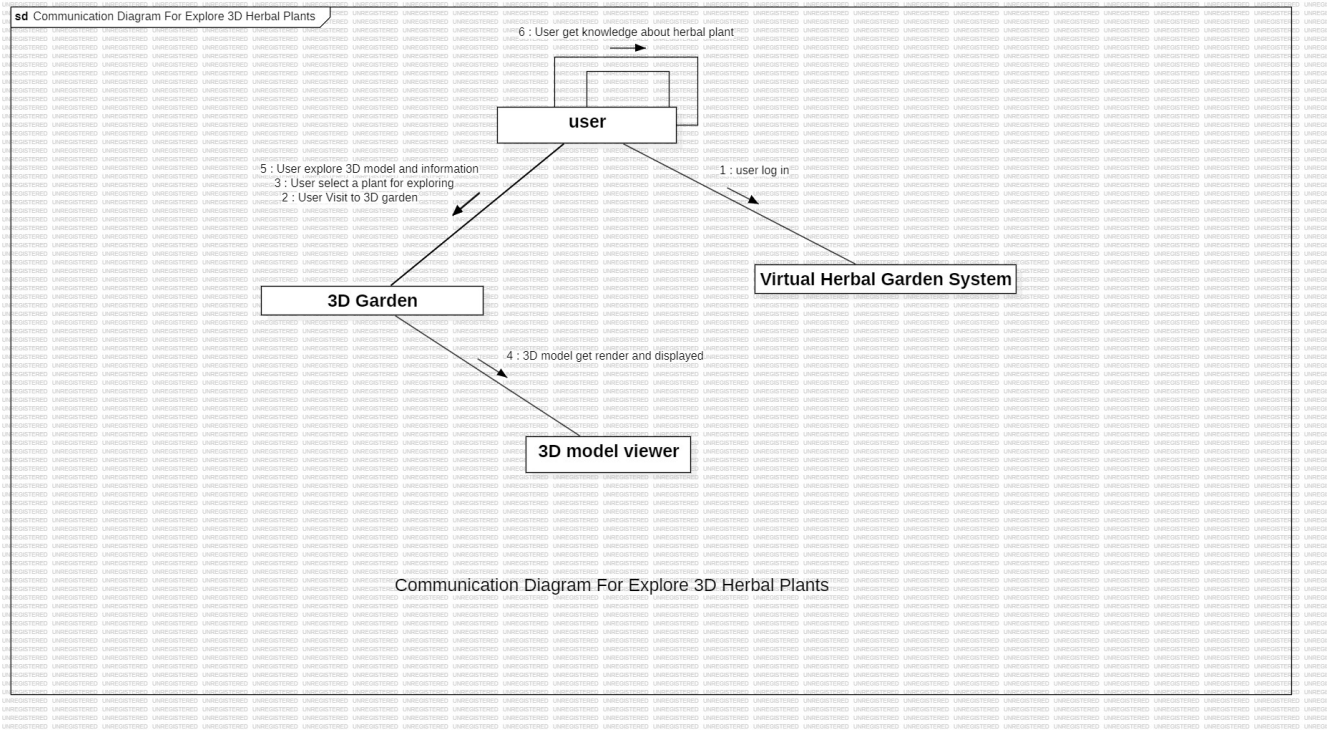

Figure: Communication Diagram

Class Diagram

Illustrates system classes, attributes, and their relationships.

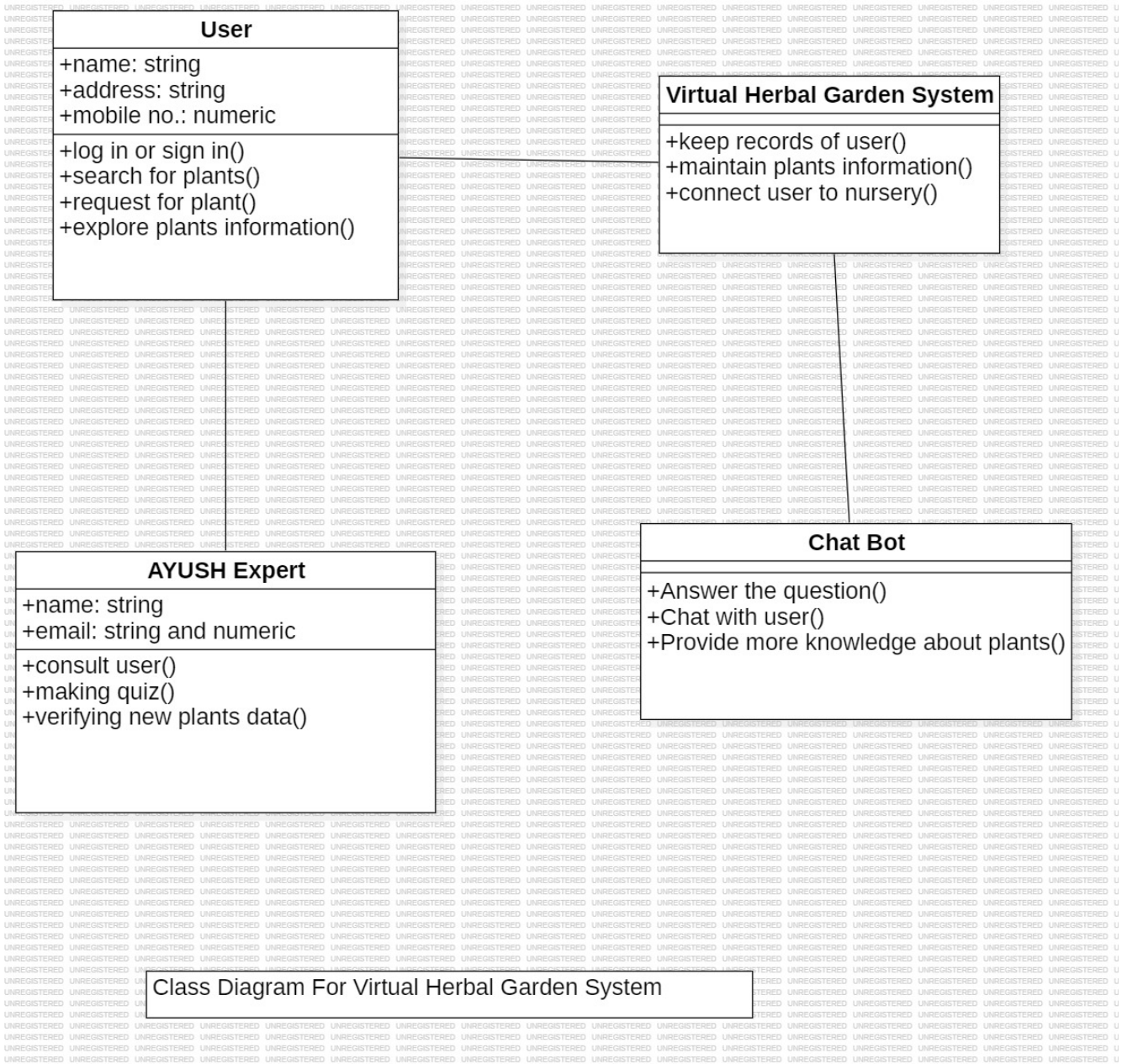

Figure: Class Diagram

Component Diagram

Illustrates system components and their Dependencies and their relationships.

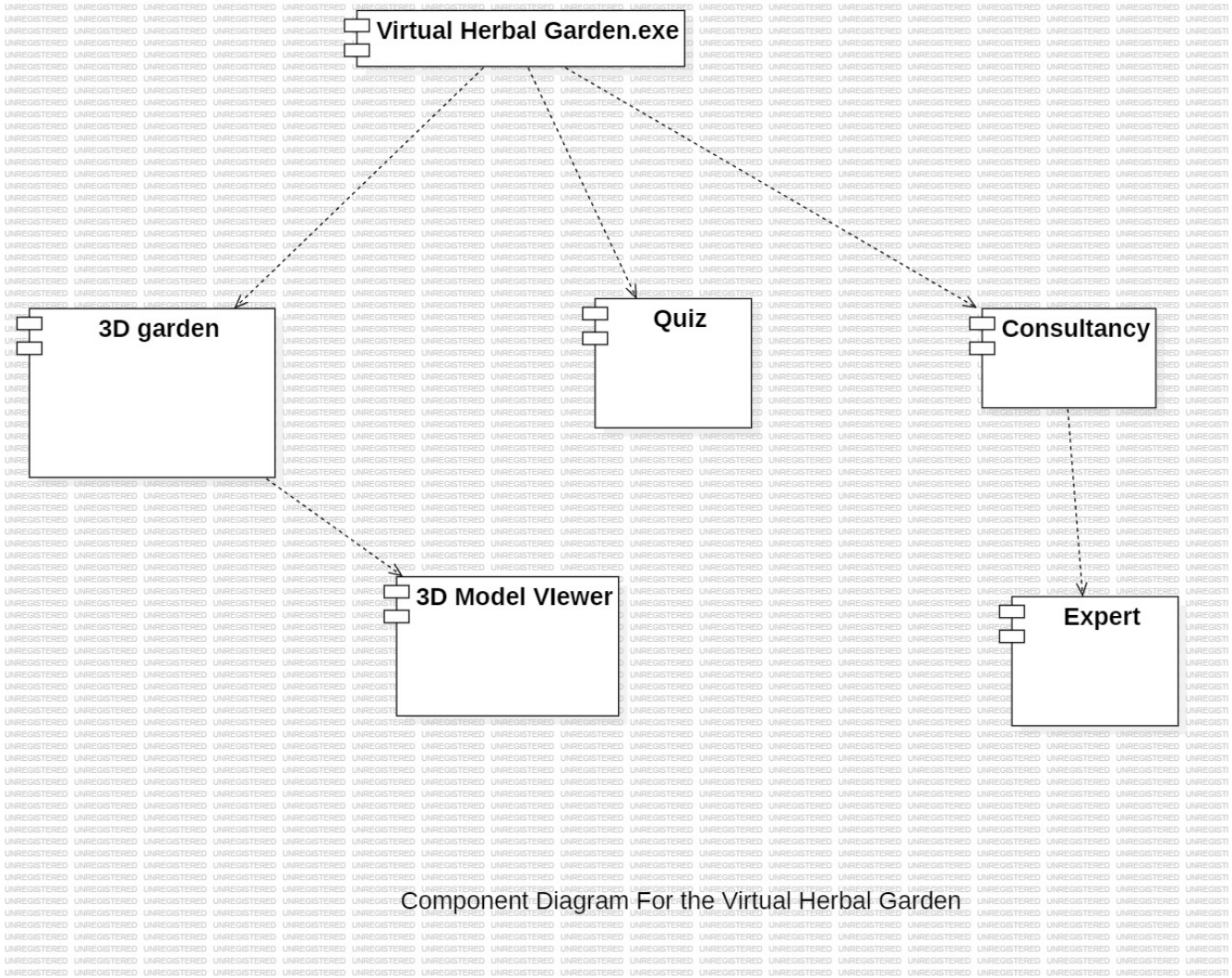

Figure: Components Diagram

Deployment Diagram

Illustrates system physical component and their interconnection.

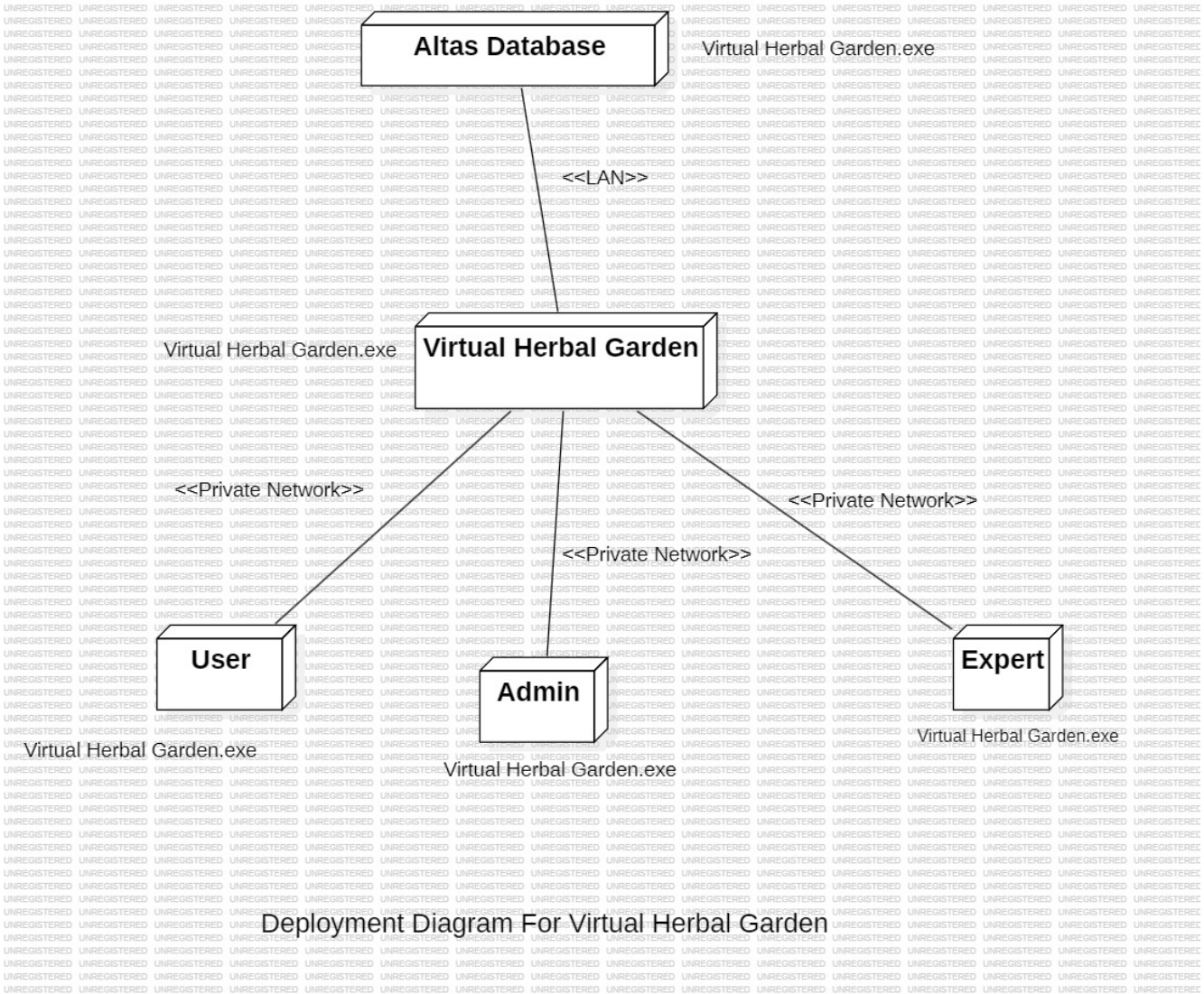

Figure: Deployment Diagram

Results and Discussions

Overview

The Virtual Herbal Garden (VR 1.0) was successfully implemented and tested across various environments and devices. This chapter presents the outcomes of the development process, followed by discussions on performance, usability, and future enhancements. The primary goal was to provide an interactive, educational, and scalable platform for herbal learning — and the results reflect the effectiveness of the proposed solution.

Key Results

1. Platform Functionality

The core functionalities were developed and tested thoroughly. These include:

- User registration, authentication, and profile management.
- Access to a searchable herb database with detailed profiles.
- Interactive growth visualization for each herb.
- Educational content integrated via tooltips, modals, and dedicated pages.
- Responsive design optimized for mobile, tablet, and desktop devices.

2. User Interface & Experience (UI/UX)

Feedback from initial user testing (via surveys and informal demo sessions) highlighted the following:

- Clean and intuitive UI that made herb exploration enjoyable.
- Minimal learning curve — users could interact without prior training.
- Smooth navigation and consistent visual theme across pages.

3. Performance and Compatibility

- Page load times were consistently under 2.5 seconds.
- No critical bugs were reported during testing phases.
- Compatibility confirmed on Chrome, Firefox, Edge, and Safari.
- Mobile testing showed fluid responsiveness and fast render times.

Discussions

Success Factors

Several elements contributed to the project's success:

- A clear understanding of user requirements gathered early on.
- Use of modern frameworks like React ensured scalability and responsiveness.
- Integration of multimedia content enhanced user engagement.

Challenges Faced

Despite the success, a few challenges were encountered:

- Integrating dynamic herb simulations required additional development time.
- Ensuring image optimization across devices affected performance tuning.
- Limited initial herb data made the database sparse until manually enriched.

User Feedback

Preliminary feedback was highly positive, with testers appreciating:

- Visual appeal and the educational value of the herb information.
- Ease of use and accessibility.
- Desire for more herbs and community features (forums, Q&A).

Conclusion and Future Work

The Virtual Herbal Garden project offers an innovative and educational platform that merges traditional herbal knowledge with modern digital interaction. It has successfully introduced users to the world of herbs through engaging content, plant growth simulations, and user-friendly interfaces. By using web technologies such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python, and MySQL, the system ensures both accessibility and scalability.

The project has been developed with a structured methodology, specifically the Waterfall Model, allowing clear progress through requirement gathering, system design, coding, and testing. The herbal platform's primary goal—to educate and promote sustainable herbal practices—has been effectively realized through detailed herb profiles, interactive experiences, and support for personalized exploration.

Future Work

- **Augmented Reality (AR):** Future integration of AR could enhance the immersive aspect of the garden experience.
- **Mobile App Development:** Creating native mobile applications to increase accessibility.
- **Expanded Herb Database:** Adding more plant species, including regional and rare herbs.
- **Community Features:** Enabling user forums, discussion boards, and herb-sharing features.
- **Gamification:** Introducing achievements, badges, or herb-growing challenges to maintain user engagement.
- **Data Analytics Dashboard:** To visualize user behavior and improve features iteratively.

Through continuous improvement and technological integration, the Virtual Herbal Garden aims to grow into a globally recognized educational and lifestyle tool that connects users with the healing and sustainable power of nature.

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Web Application Screenshots

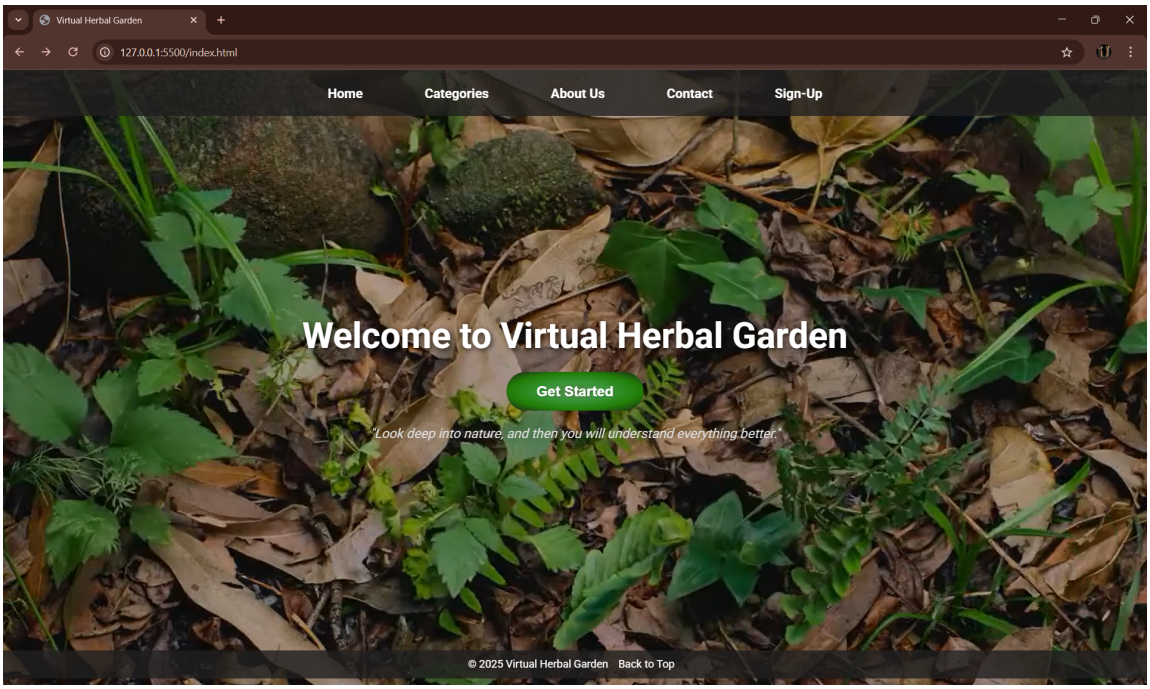

Figure 1: Landing Page of Virtual Herbal Garden

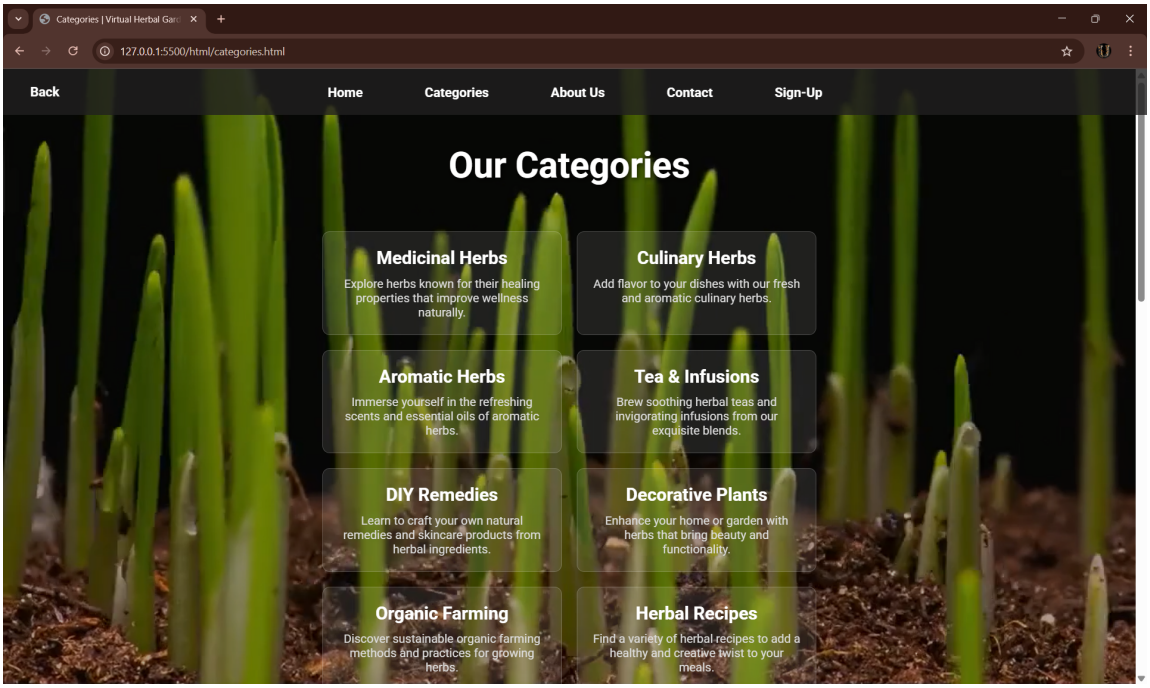

Figure 2: Categories

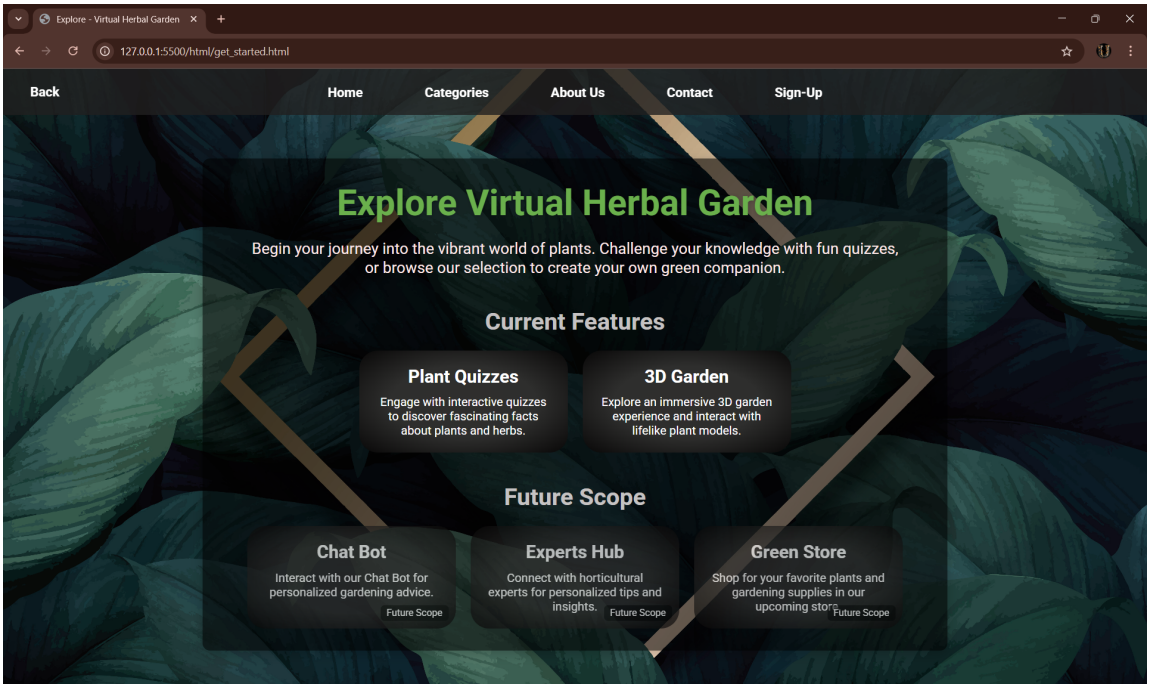

Figure 3: Explore Features

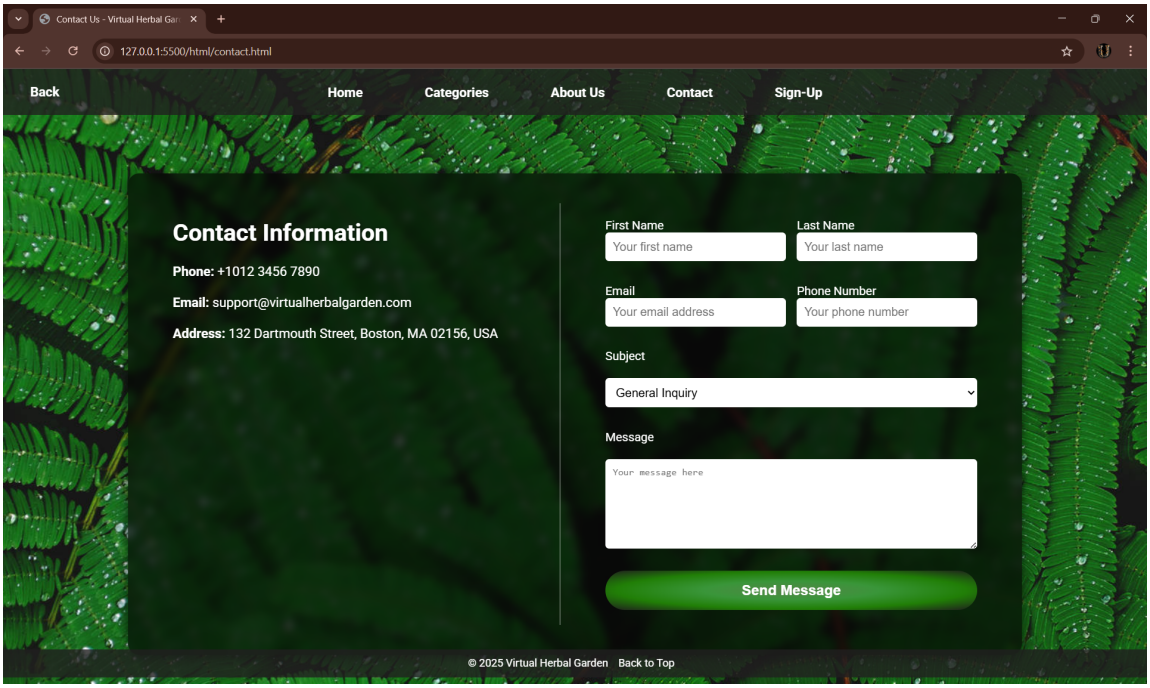

Figure 4: Contact us

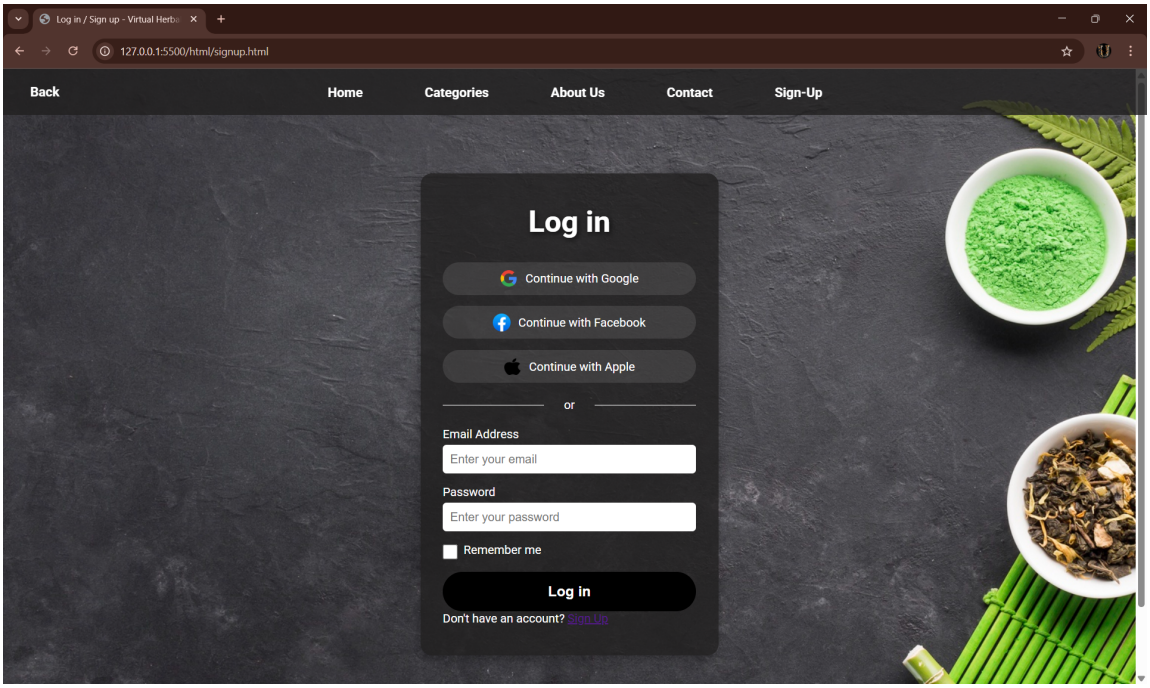

Figure 5: Log In

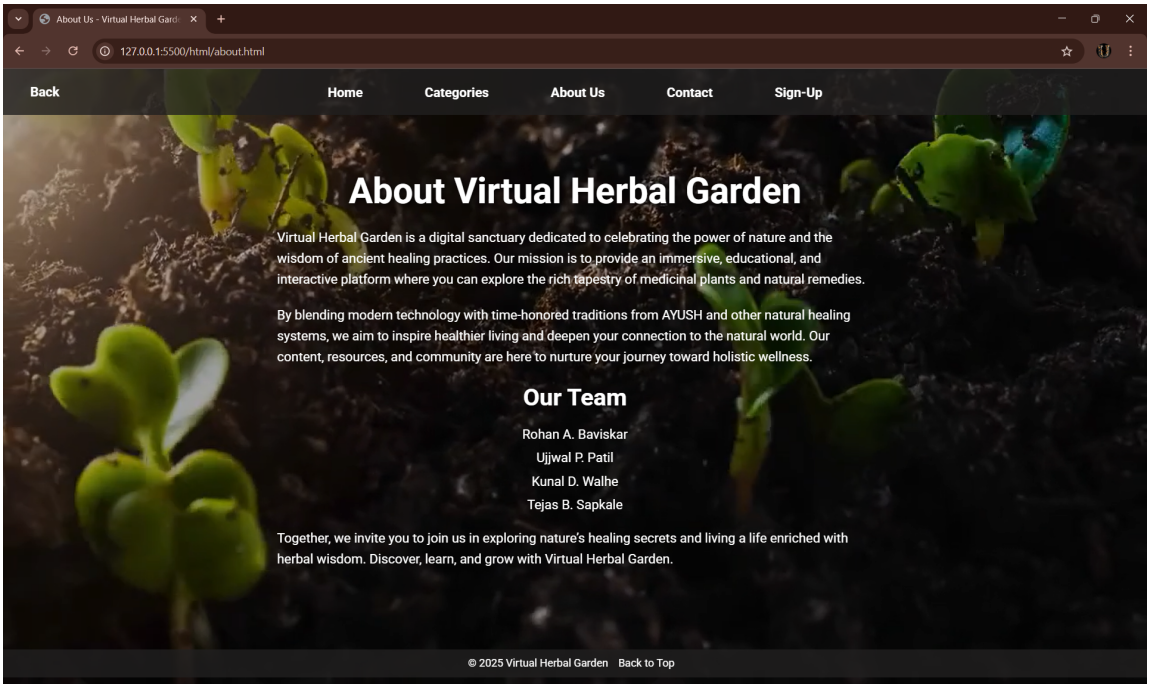

Figure 6: About

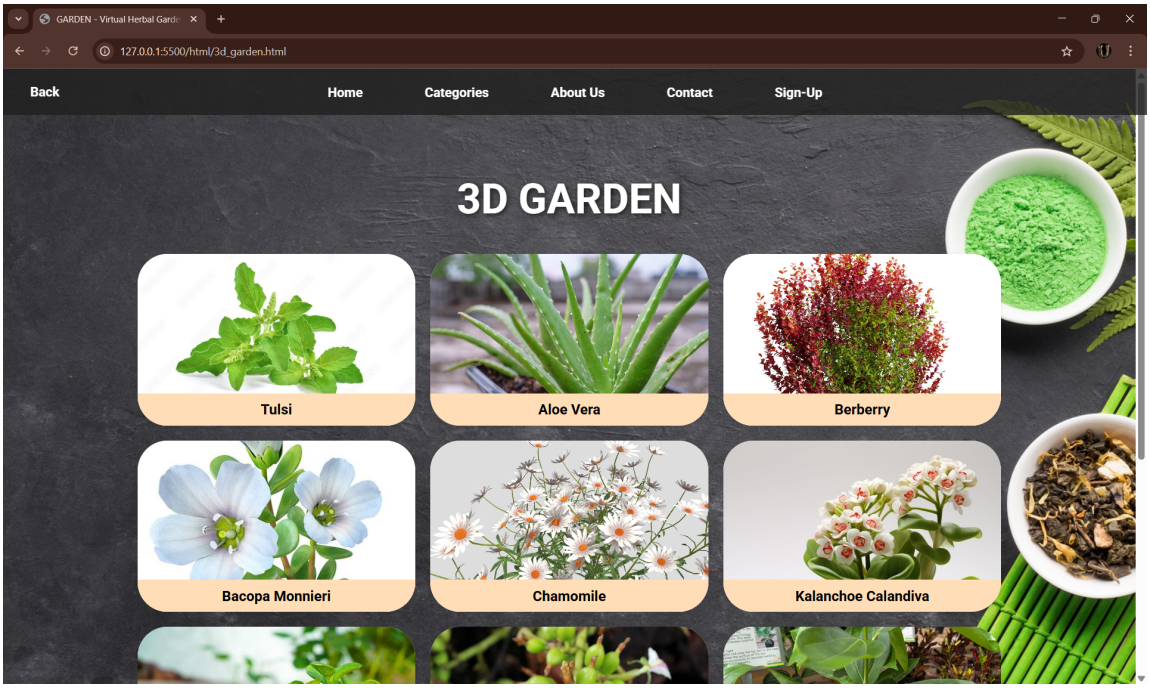

Figure 7: 3D Garden

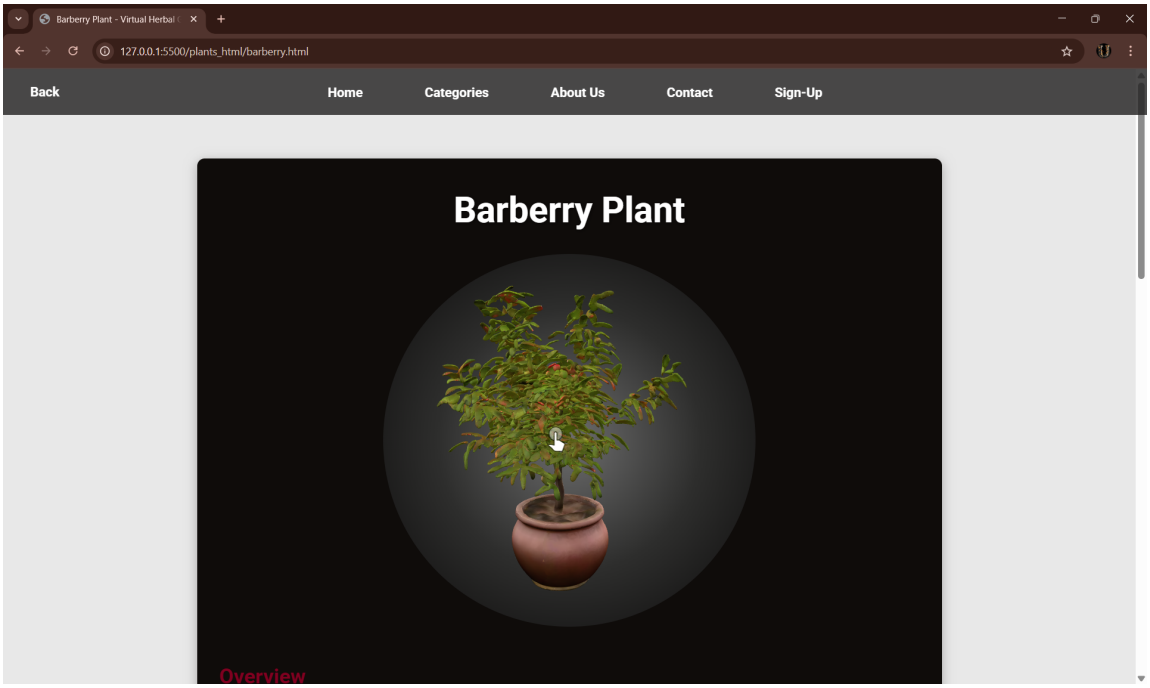

Figure 8: D plant preview

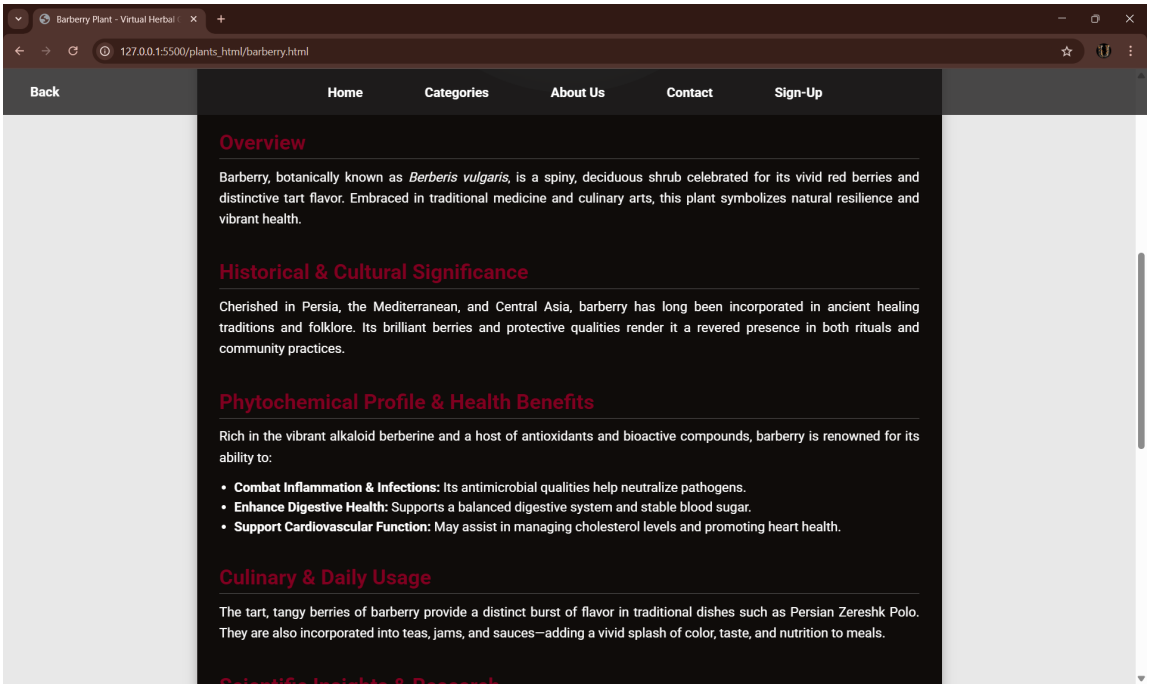

Figure 9: Plant Information

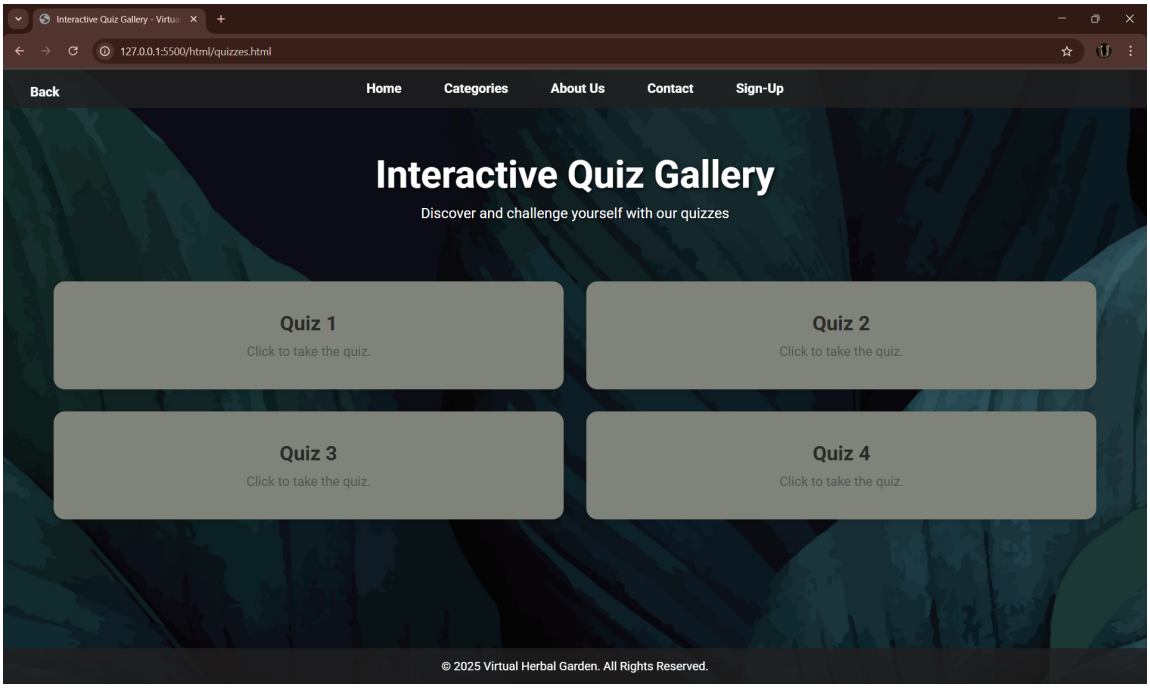

Figure 10: Quizzes